a. Helicoid: Axis develops on only one side and forms a coil structure atleast at the earlier development stage. Example: *Hamelia*, potato.

b. Scorpioid (chinchinnus): Axis develops on alternate sides and often becomes a coiled structure. Example: *Heliotropium*.

3. Simple dichasium (Biparous): A central axis ends in a terminal flower; further growth is produced by two lateral buds. Each cymose unit consists of three flowers of which central one is old one. This is **true cyme**. Example: *Jasminum*.

4. **Compound dichasium**: It has many flowers. A terminal old flower develops lateral simple dichasial cymes on both sides. Each compound dichasium consists of seven flowers. Example: *Clerodendron*.

A small,simple dichasium is called **cymule**

5. Polychasial Cyme (multiparous): The central axis ends with a flower. The lateral axis branches repeatedly. Example: *Nerium*



Sympodial Cyme: In monochasial cyme, successive axis at first develop in a zigzag manner and later it develops into a straight pseudo axis. Example: *Solanum americanum*.

III. Mixed Inflorescence

Inflorescences in which both racemose and cymose patterns of development occur in a mixed manner. It is of the following two types.

1. Thyrsus: It is a '**Raceme of cymes**'. Indefinite central axis bears lateral pedicellate cymes, (simple or compound dichasia). Example: *Ocimum*.

2. Verticillaster: Main axis bears two opposite lateral sessile cymes at the axil of the node,each of it produces monochasial scorpioid lateral branches so that flowers

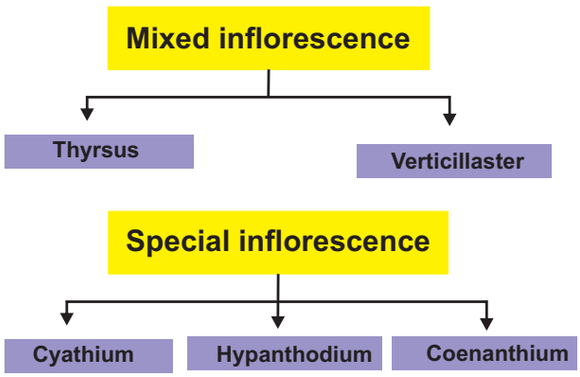


Figure 4.6: Mixed and special inflorescence

are crowded around the node. Example: *Leucas*.

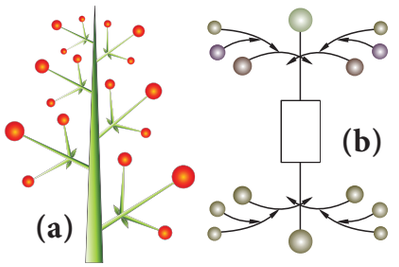


Figure 4.7: Diagrammatic representation of, **(a)** Thyrsus, **(b)** Verticillaster

IV. Special Inflorescence

The inflorescence that do not show any of the development pattern types are classified under special type of inflorescence.

1. Cyathium: Cyathium inflorescence consists of small unisexual flowers enclosed by a common involucre which mimics a single flower. Male flowers are organised in a scorpioid manner. Female flower is solitary and centrally located on a long pedicel. Male flower is represented only by stamens and female flower is represented only by a pistil. Cyathium may be actinomorphic (Example: *Euphorbia*) or zygomorphic (Example: *Pedilanthus*). Nectar is present in involucre.

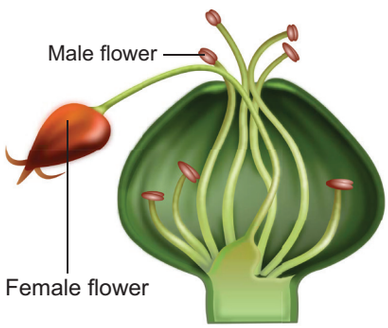


Figure 4.8: Cyathium

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